



13 DAY CHERRY BLOSSOMS OF JAPAN WITH HIROSHIMA

Tokyo, Mount Fuji, Hamamatsu, Nagoya, Nara, Osaka, Hiroshima, Kyoto

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Tour code **AVGJP-13**



International Flights Included

Round-trip airfare is covered in this tour



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HIGHLIGHTS

- Explore **Tokyo's Asakusa** neighbourhood, home to the ancient **Sensō-ji Temple**. Marvel at the grand Kaminarimon Gate and stroll along Nakamise Street, which offers a vibrant selection of traditional crafts and Japanese treats.
- Visit **Nara's** historic **Tōdai-ji Temple**, home to Japan's largest bronze Buddha statue, Daibutsu. Explore Nara Park where you'll encounter friendly sika deer roaming freely, adding a unique charm to this cultural experience.
- **Osaka Castle**: Discover the historical Osaka Castle, a stunning example of Japanese architecture from the 16th century. This iconic landmark played a pivotal role in Japan's feudal history and offers visitors a glimpse into the country's rich heritage.
- **Fushimi Inari Taisha in Kyoto**: Stroll through the thousands of red torii gates at Fushimi Inari Taisha, one of Japan's most photographed sites. This shrine, dedicated to the Shinto god Inari, provides an unforgettable experience as you walk through its winding paths in the serene forested hills.
- **Himeji Castle**: Marvel at Himeji Castle, also known as the White Heron Castle, renowned for its elegant design and historical significance. As one of Japan's few remaining original castles, Himeji Castle offers a glimpse into the grandeur of Japan's medieval architecture.
- **Explore More**: Looking for a longer tour? Here are some options that allow you to gain a deeper insight into the region.

ITINERARY

Day 1: Arrive in Tokyo, Japan

Welcome to Tokyo – Japan!

Upon arrival, please arrange your own airport transfers to your hotel or contact our travel consultant to get the airport transfer quote. Check in your hotel and the rest of the day at leisure or explore the city on your own.

Important Information:

- The standard check-in time at the hotel is 03.00pm. If you arrive before the standard check-in time of, you can leave the luggage at the hotel reception until a room is available. Although early check-in may be permitted, it is subject to availability and solely at the hotel's sole discretion. Any fees associated with early check-in must be paid directly to the hotel.*



Meal: N/A



Accommodation: Toyoko Inn Narita Airport Shinkan 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 2: Tokyo 🚗 City Tour

After breakfast, you'll embark on a full day of exploring Tokyo with an English-speaking guide. The day begins with a visit to the Hokusai Museum, dedicated to the renowned Japanese artist who spent his entire life in Tokyo.

Next, you'll explore the vibrant Asakusa district, home to Senso-ji Temple, the city's oldest temple, and the bustling Nakamise-dori street lined with traditional shops. The tour continues with a stroll around the Imperial Palace, featuring the iconic Nijubashi bridge, and a visit to the sophisticated Ginza district. The day concludes with a stop at the Bunkyo Civic Center, where you can enjoy panoramic views of the sprawling metropolis from its observation deck.



Meal: Breakfast.



Accommodation: KOKO Hotels premier Nihonbashi Hamacho 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 3: Tokyo 🚗 Hakone 🚗 Lake Ashi 🚗 Kawaguchiko

After breakfast, depart Tokyo and journey to the picturesque Hakone national park. Upon arrival, enjoy a boat cruise on Lake Ashi, set within the caldera of Mount Hakone and renowned for its views of Mount Fuji. The lake's western-inspired boats offer scenic rides through this forested area, which has long attracted hikers and sightseers.

Next, travel to Lake Kawaguchiko, the second largest of the Fuji Five Lakes, known for its breathtaking vistas of Mount Fuji. Check into your hotel and enjoy a delicious dinner. The evening is yours to explore the local nightlife at your leisure.



Meal: Breakfast.



Accommodation: The Celestion Hotel Gotemba interchange 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 4: Kawaguchiko Mt. Fuji Hamamatsu.

Today, we departed Kawaguchiko and traveled by coach to Mount Fuji's 5th Station (weather permitting). This point is halfway up Japan's tallest peak, known as one of the country's three holy mountains. From here, if the weather is clear, we'll enjoy views of the majestic summit above the clouds.

Following your exploration of the Mount Fuji area, you'll continue your journey to Hamamatsu. Upon arrival, you'll have the evening free to relax and explore at your own pace. Enjoy an overnight stay in Hamamatsu.



Meal: Breakfast



Accommodation: Hotel Route Inn Hamamatsu Dealer Dori 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 5: Hamamatsu Nara Osaka

Today, we'll travel to Nara, renowned for its historic temples and free-roaming deer. Our first stop is Tōdai-ji (Great Eastern Temple), one of Japan's most iconic temples. This grand structure houses one of Japan's largest bronze Buddha statues, known as Daibutsu. After visiting the temple, we'll take a leisurely stroll through Nara Park, where you can encounter hundreds of friendly sika deer roaming freely.

Following our time in Nara, we'll head to Osaka. There, you'll embark on a walking tour of the lively Dōtonbori area. This bustling district, running alongside the Dōtonbori Canal, is famous for its vibrant shopping scene, delicious street food, lively bars, and entertainment options. As evening falls, the area lights up with a dazzling array of colorful neon signs and mechanized displays, including the iconic Glico Man and Kani Doraku crab signs. After the tour, you'll have the evening free to enjoy Osaka at your leisure.



Meal: Breakfast



Accommodation: KOKO HOTEL Osaka Shinsaibashi 4* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 6: Osaka Free Day

Today, you have free time to explore Osaka at your leisure.

You can wander through its vibrant shopping districts, savor local cuisine, or visit landmarks like Osaka Castle. Alternatively, you may purchase an optional tour to Kyoto, where you can see highlights such as Fushimi Inari Shrine or Kinkaku-ji (Golden Pavilion).



Meal: Breakfast.



Accommodation: KOKO HOTEL Osaka Shinsaibashi 4* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 7: Osaka 🚗 Himeji 🚗 Kuraishiki 🚗 Hiroshima

After breakfast, depart Osaka to visit Himeji Castle, also known as the “White Heron Castle.” This UNESCO World Heritage Site is the largest surviving example of a traditional Japanese castle, consisting of 83 buildings. Its white roof, reminiscent of a heron in flight, gives it its popular name, Shirasagi-jō. Enjoy stunning views of Himeji city from the castle grounds.

Next, travel to Kurashiki, located on Japan’s Seto Inland Sea. Explore the Bikan Historical Quarter, renowned for its well-preserved historic buildings and charming local shops. After your visit, transfer to your hotel in Hiroshima.



Meal: Breakfast



Accommodation: HOTEL MYSTAYS Hiroshima Peace Park 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 8: Hiroshima Miyajima Island Osaka

After breakfast, board a ferry for a short trip to Miyajima Island, renowned for its lush forests and ancient temples. On arrival, visit the iconic “floating” torii gate, which appears to be partially submerged at high tide and marks the entrance to Itsukushima Shrine, first built in the 12th century. Nearby, explore the Museum of History and Folklore, housed in a 19th-century merchant’s home and showcasing cultural artifacts. Enjoy a stroll along Omotesando Shopping Street, where you can grab lunch before returning to Hiroshima by ferry. Upon returning to Hiroshima, visit the Atomic Bomb Dome, or Genbaku Dome, the Hiroshima Peace Memorial. This partially ruined building is one of the few structures that survived the 1945 atomic bombing and stands as a powerful symbol of the city’s resilience and the tragedy of war.

Next, tour the Hiroshima Peace Memorial Museum, which features moving and significant exhibits. The eternal flame in the cenotaph symbolizes the city’s hope for the abolition of nuclear weapons, intended to burn until the last nuclear weapon is destroyed.

Afterwards we made our way back to Osaka. Upon arrival, check in at your hotel and relax.



Meal: Breakfast



Accommodation: KOKO HOTEL Osaka Shinsaibashi 4* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 9: Osaka Kyoto

Today, embark on a full-day coach tour of Kyoto. The first stop in Kyoto is Fushimi Inari Taisha, one of the most iconic sights in Japan with thousands of red Shinto shrine gates. The shrine is dedicated to Inari, the Shinto god of rice, and is famous for its thousands of vermilion torii gates that form a winding path through the forested hills of Mount Inari. We strolled through the gates and visited the various shrines and temples. Afterwards, we continue to the Arashiyama Bamboo Grove for an enchanting walk through the towering bamboo forest. Aside from the bamboo grove, visitors can also explore other attractions in the Arashiyama district, including the Togetsukyo Bridge, which offers a picturesque view of the Katsura River and the surrounding mountains.

Our last stop in Kyoto is the World Heritage-list Golden Pavilion, also known as Kinkaku-ji. It is renowned for its stunning golden facade, covered in gold leaf and reflects beautifully in the pond in front of it the temple. The three-story pagoda- style structure was originally built in the 14th century as a retirement villa for a shogun and was later converted into a temple by his son. Then we will transfer to the hotel for check-in.



Meal: Breakfast



Accommodation: R Hotel Namba 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 10: Kyoto

Today, you have free time to explore Kyoto at your leisure. Overnight at hotel in Kyoto



Meal: Breakfast



Accommodation: R Hotel Namba 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 11: Kyoto Osaka

Today, you have free time to explore Osaka at your leisure.



Meal: Breakfast.



Accommodation: R Hotel Namba 3* or Similar

ITINERARY

Day 12: Osaka ✈ Home

Enjoy breakfast at the hotel. You will have free time to explore or relax until it's time to head to the airport flight home



Meal: Breakfast.



Accommodation: On Plane

ITINERARY

Day 13: Home

You arrive your home today and end your amazing holiday in Japan with AVG Travels

INCLUSIONS

- ✓ **Return international flights**
- ✓ Airport transfers
- ✓ 11 nights combine 3 & 4-star hotels with daily breakfast
- ✓ Tour Tokyo including the historic Asakusa neighbourhood and the Nakamise shopping precinct
- ✓ Take in views of Mount Fuji
- ✓ Visit Nara, famous for its many temples and its free-roaming deer and Todaiji, one of Japan's most famous temples.
- ✓ Visit Hiroshima and Miyajima Island
- ✓ Local English-speaking tour guides
- ✓ Comfortable, dedicated transportation throughout

EXCLUSIONS

- ✕ **Compulsory Tipping** for the driver and tour guide is AU\$10 per person per day. This will be collected by your tour guide upon your arrival in Japan.
- ✕ Travel insurance
- ✕ Visas if you do not hold Australian Passport
- ✕ Anything not mentioned in the itinerary
- ✕ Optional activities
- ✕ Personal expenses

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****This itinerary is a draft version and will be finalised closer to your departure date.***

